

CentCompras — User Manual: Edge cases, limits & troubleshooting

Reference · Version 1.0 · For warehouse staff, branch staff, and administrators

Companion to: [Item Console](#) · [Purchase Orders](#) · [Goods receipt & stock](#) · [Branches & Requisição interna](#) · [Admin & Superuser Reference](#) · [Manager catalog](#) · [Request threads](#) · [Company Voice](#).

Those manuals teach the normal path. **This one is the lookup reference** for the boundaries: the exact errors you can hit, the hard numeric limits, the state-machine rules, and the things that are deliberately not built yet. When something "won't let you", look here.

1. How to use this manual

- **"I got an error message"** → §2, find the message, read the fix.
- **"Is there a limit on ...?"** → §3 (numeric limits table).
- **"Why can't I move it from A to B?"** → §4 (state machines).
- **"Why did my number round like that?"** → §5 (money & VAT).
- **"Can two people overwrite each other?"** → §6 (concurrency & audit).
- **"Is X built yet?"** → §7 (known gaps).

A message that "won't let you" is the app **protecting the ledger** — not a bug.

2. Error messages & what they mean

2.1 Catalogue (item console — `/manage/items/`)

Message (exact)	Why it appears	What to do
Internal code "X" is already used by another item.	Internal codes are unique, case-insensitive	Use a different code
Internal code may only contain letters, digits, dots, hyphens, and underscores.	The code contains a space or a disallowed character (only A–Z, a–z, 0–9, ., -, _ are allowed)	Fix the code (e.g. CEM-50 , CABLE-2.5)
Internal code cannot be changed after the item is saved.	You tried to rename a code on an existing item	Codes are locked after first save (legacy empty codes may be set once)
Item cannot be activated (Genesis): missing ...	First activation (Genesis) needs internal code, description, unit, VAT, active family, and retail price > 0 (console save, Django admin Reactivate bulk action, or <code>add_item --activate</code>)	Complete the fields before activating

Message (exact)	Why it appears	What to do
Family name "X" is already used.	Family names are unique, case-insensitive	Use another name
Supplier name "X" is already used.	Supplier names are unique, case-insensitive	Use another name
Family name is required. / Supplier name is required. / Description is required.	Required field empty	Fill it in
Cannot assign items to inactive family 'X'.	You tried to put an item in a deactivated family	Reactivate the family, or pick an active one
Sub-family name is required.	Sub-family create with an empty name	Type a name
Sub-family name "X" is already used in this family.	Duplicate sub-family name under the same family	Use another name
Cannot assign items to inactive sub-family 'X'.	Item form or save used a deactivated sub-family	Reactivate the sub-family, clear the field, or pick an active one
Sub-family does not belong to the selected family.	Item family and sub-family parent do not match	Pick a sub-family under the chosen family, or clear sub-family
A reason is required to deactivate an item.	Item deactivation always needs a reason	Choose Temporarily unavailable / No longer commercialized / Other
A reason is required to activate an item.	Reactivation needs a reason	Give one (e.g. Genesis on first activation)
Enter a valid email address.	Supplier email is malformed	Fix the email (or clear it)
...selling price must be zero or greater.	Prices can't be negative	Enter 0 (means "not priced") or a positive number
...reorder level must be zero or greater.	Reorder level can't be negative	Enter 0 or a positive number
--retail-price must be greater than 0 when using --activate.	add_item CLI was run with --activate but retail price is missing or zero	Pass --retail-price with a value greater than 0

Family names are immutable — the console has no "rename". If a name is wrong, deactivate it and create a new family (items keep the old family; you can't add new items to an inactive family).

Sub-family names and parent family are immutable after create — same pattern as families. Deactivate and create a new sub-family if the label was wrong.

New items: confirm **Genesis** on save — create and activation are atomic (no inactive orphan if you cancel). **Internal code** is required and locked after save.

Manager catalog (`/manage/catalog/`) — read-only stock + prices for warehouse staff. See [Manager catalog](#).

Message (exact)	Why it appears	What to do
No items to show.	No active items in active families	Create or reactivate items in the item console
No items match these filters.	Search, family, or “below reorder only” hid every row	Clear filters (All families, untick the checkbox)
Could not load the catalog.	Catalog API failed	Refresh; if it persists, ask an administrator
The request could not be completed.	Request failed without a specific message	Refresh; try again
Catalogue view permission required	Not a warehouse user (typical for branch-only logins)	Use <code>/branch/</code> and branch pages, or ask head office for a warehouse group

Below reorder is `reorder_level > 0` **and** `stock ≤ reorder`. Reorder **0** never flags. Buying price = primary supplier’s cost, else cheapest among **active** suppliers (else —).

2.2 Purchase orders (`/manage/purchase-orders/`)

Message	Why	What to do
This supplier does not have a price for item X (id=N).	That supplier has no <code>SupplierItemPrice</code> for the item — no cross-supplier fallback	Add a supplier price for that supplier+item, or choose a different item
Cannot use inactive supplier 'X'. / Cannot use inactive item 'X'.	The supplier or item was deactivated	Reactivate, or pick another
This purchase order already has a line for 'X'.	One line per item per PO (no merging)	Edit the existing line's quantity instead
Purchase order lines can only be changed while the order is a draft.	You tried to add/edit/remove a line after submit	Only drafts are editable
Cannot submit a purchase order without lines.	Submitting an empty PO	Add at least one line
quantity must be greater than zero. / quantity is too large.	Quantity ≤ 0 , or $\geq 1,000,000,000$	Use a quantity in <code>(0, 1e9)</code>
unit_cost must be zero or greater.	Negative unit cost	Enter 0 or positive
...must be between 0 and 100.	A discount is negative or $> 100\%$	Use 0–100
Commercial, financial and rappel discounts cannot exceed 100% combined.	The three % add up past 100	Lower them
Cannot move a purchase order from 'X' to 'Y'.	Illegal transition	See §4
You do not have permission to approve this purchase order.	Operator, or grade too low	Operators never approve; managers need grade 2+

Message	Why	What to do
An approver is required.	Approval without a user	Internal/system error — report it
Self-approval is limited to ... EUR gross (this PO is ...).	You're approving your own PO over your self cap	Ask another approver
Approval is limited to ... EUR gross (this PO is ...).	Approving someone else's PO over your cap	Ask a higher-grade approver
No approval limit is configured for this grade.	Missing ApprovalLimit row	Ask a warehouse admin to set it
Only warehouse admins can change approval limits.	Editing caps as non-admin	Warehouse admin only
A reason is required to reject a purchase order.	Reject needs a reason	Type one
A reason is required to close a purchase order with remaining quantity.	Manual close (short shipment) needs a reason	Type one
A reason is required to cancel a purchase order.	Cancel needs a reason	Type one
A purchase order with receipts cannot be cancelled. Close it instead to accept a short shipment.	You can't cancel an approved PO that already received goods	Use close (short shipment) instead
Purchase order totals exceed the maximum supported value.	Totals $\geq 1,000,000,000,000$	Lower quantities/prices

2.3 Inventory — goods receipt, goods issue, branch stock

Goods receipt (/manage/goods-receipts/)

Message	Why	What to do
Cannot receive goods against a purchase order with status 'X'.	PO isn't approved or received	Approve it first
Purchase order line not found on this purchase order.	Line id doesn't belong to that PO	Re-select
Each receipt line must be a valid object with line_id and quantity_received.	Malformed line	Fix the form
A purchase order line was provided more than once in this receipt.	Duplicate line in one receipt	One row per PO line
Received quantity X exceeds remaining Y for PO line N.	Over-receipt	You can't receive more than ordered
No lines to receive.	Empty receipt	Add a line
Stock cannot be adjusted below zero.	Would make on-hand negative	Check your quantities
Cannot reduce stock of 'X' below N reserved for approved requests.		

Message	Why	What to do
	A negative adjust would steal units already held for requisições	Short-close or cancel the hold first, then adjust
A reason is required to adjust stock.	adjust_stock needs a reason	Type one

Goods issue (warehouse, /manage/internal-requests/)

Message	Why	What to do
Cannot issue goods against a request with status 'X'.	Request isn't approved or fulfilling	Only those are issuable
Request line not found on this request.	Wrong line id	Re-select
Issued quantity X exceeds remaining Y for request line N.	Over-issue vs the request	Lower it
Cannot issue X of 'Y': Z reserved for this request.	Over-issue vs this request's hold	Issue only the reserved qty, or wait for incoming stock to be allocated
Insufficient stock for 'X': N requested, M on hand.	Over-issue vs on-hand (safety net)	The warehouse must procure first
No lines to issue.	Empty issue	Add a line
A reason is required to short-close a request.	Warehouse short-close needs a reason	Type one

Branch receipt & branch stock (/branch/receipts/)

Message	Why	What to do
Cannot receive against a request with status 'X'.	Request isn't shipped or received	Wait for dispatch
Goods issue line not found on this dispatch.	Wrong line id	Re-select
A goods issue line was provided more than once in this receipt.	Duplicate line	One row per issue line
Received quantity X exceeds shipped remaining Y.	Over-receipt vs the dispatch	Lower it
Only branch admins can adjust branch stock.	Non-admin tried adjust_branch_stock	Branch admin only
Branch stock cannot be adjusted below zero.	Negative branch balance	Check your quantities
A reason is required to adjust branch stock.	Branch adjustment needs a reason	Type one
A reason is required to short-close a request.	Branch short-close needs a reason	Type one

2.4 Requisição interna (/branch/requests/) & branches

Message	Why	What to do
Item 'X' has no wholesale price.	Wholesale is 0 — the requisição is priced from wholesale	Set a wholesale price (warehouse), or pick another item
This request already has a line for 'X'.	One line per item (no merging)	Edit the existing line
Cannot use inactive item 'X'. / Cannot use inactive branch 'X'.	Item or branch deactivated	Reactivate, or pick another
Internal request lines can only be changed while the request is a draft.	Editing after submit	Only drafts are editable
Cannot submit a request without lines.	Empty request	Add a line
Cannot move an internal request from 'X' to 'Y'.	Illegal transition	See §4
You do not have permission to approve or cancel this request.	Operator (or cancelling approved as operator)	Manager/admin only
Self-approval is limited to ... EUR gross (this request is ...).	Manager approving own request over self cap	Ask another manager
Approval is limited to ... EUR gross (this request is ...).	Manager over others cap	Ask a higher approver
No branch approval limit is configured for managers.	Missing BranchApprovalLimit	Warehouse admin sets it
A reason is required to reject a request.	Reject needs a reason	Type one
A reason is required to cancel an approved request.	Cancel-approved needs a reason	Type one
A request with goods issues cannot be cancelled.	Goods already shipped	Short-close instead (see §4)
client_uuid is required.	Offline sync POST missing UUID	Retry from the branch requests page after reconnect
client_uuid must be a valid UUID.	Malformed offline sync payload	Refresh the page and create a new offline draft
client_uuid is already in use on another branch.	Offline draft UUID was synced on a different branch	Switch back to the branch where the draft was created, then open /branch/requests/
Request body must be valid JSON. / Request body must be a JSON object.	Malformed or non-object sync/create body	Retry from the branch requests page; do not POST arrays
Unknown item id ...	Stale or invalid catalogue item in offline sync payload	Refresh the catalogue online, then recreate the offline draft
Cached catalogue is for another branch. Connect to Wi-Fi to	Offline browse after switching branch without refreshing	

Message	Why	What to do
download this branch's catalogue.		Connect to Wi-Fi on the current branch to download its catalogue

2.5 Request threads (/branch/threads/ , /manage/threads/)

Message	Why	What to do
A subject is required. / Subject must be a string.	Empty or non-text subject	Type a short title
Request body must be valid JSON. / Request body must be a JSON object.	Malformed create/reply/close body	Use the website form
A message is required. / Message must be a string.	Empty or non-text first message / reply	Type the message
This thread is closed. No further messages can be posted.	Reply after close	Open a new thread
Only the person who opened the thread can close it.	You are not the opener and cannot override	Ask the opener, or a branch manager/admin / warehouse admin
A reason is required to close a thread.	Close without a valid reason	Pick Request Satisfied or Other
A reason text is required when 'Other' is selected.	Other with a blank textbox	Type the reason
Satisfaction must be between 1 and 5 stars.	Rating missing, a decimal, or out of range	Pick 1-5 whole stars (opener close only)
Cannot use inactive branch 'X'.	Opening a thread on a deactivated branch	Switch to an active branch
The opener must be a member of the branch.	Service-level: opener is not a member of that branch	Open from your own branch
Only warehouse staff can link items to a thread.	A branch user tried to link	Warehouse users link from /manage/threads/
One or more items were not found.	Link used a stale or unknown item id	Search again and pick a live catalogue item
No items to link.	Empty link request	Pick at least one item
branch_id must be an integer.	Warehouse list ?branch_id= is not a number	Use the branch filter, or omit it

Satisfaction is stored only when the **opener** closes (default 1★). Override close leaves satisfaction empty.

Unread: GET-ing a thread's messages does **not** mark it read. Clicking the thread in the list (POST mark-read) does.

2.6 Company Voice (/company-voice/)

Message (exact)	Why it appears	What to do
Message body cannot be empty.	Blank or whitespace-only post/comment	Type a message
Message body cannot exceed 4000 characters.	Body longer than 4000 characters	Shorten the text
The edit window has expired.	Edit more than 15 minutes after posting	You can still delete; you cannot edit
Only the author can change or delete this message.	Someone else tried to edit/delete	Only the author can
This message has been deleted.	Second delete, or edit of a deleted row	Refresh the feed
This post has been deleted.	Comment on a post the author already deleted	Refresh; the post is a tombstone
Invalid tag.	Tag is not praise/concern/suggestion/wish	Pick a tag from the list, or leave untagged
Request body must be valid JSON.	Malformed API body	Use the website form
Body must be a string.	API sent a non-text body	Send text
is_anonymous must be a boolean.	API sent "false" / 1 instead of true / false	Use a real boolean
This message was changed in another tab. Refresh and try again.	Two edits of the same message; the second used a stale updated_at (HTTP 409)	Refresh and re-apply your change
updated_at is required. / updated_at must be an ISO timestamp.	PATCH omitted or malformed version token	Refresh; the website sends this automatically

(edited) is stored as `edited_at` — a new post is never labelled edited. Reply counts ignore soft-deleted comments.

2.7 Account, permissions & isolation

What you see	When	Meaning
Authentication required (401, JSON API)	Not signed in	Sign in
Account is inactive (403)	Your account was deactivated — you're signed out automatically	Contact your administrator
Branch membership required (403)	A warehouse-only user opened a /branch/... page	You need a branch role
No active branch selected (403)	Branch user with no branch chosen	Use the picker
Internal request view permission required (403)	A non-warehouse user opened /manage/internal-requests/	Warehouse role needed
	You lack a specific capability	See the role tables in 01-04

What you see	When	Meaning
Missing permission: ... (403)		
404 "not found"	A request/dispatch from another branch	Branch data is 404 , not 403 — other branches are invisible, not merely forbidden

Tip: **403 vs 404**: "You can't do that with your role" → **403**. "That row belongs to another branch" → **404** (on purpose, so you can't even confirm it exists).

3. Numeric limits & precision

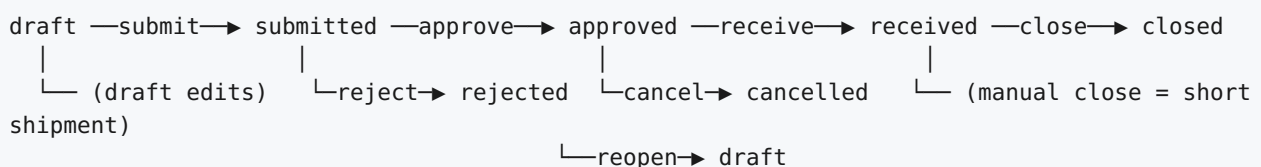
Field	Storage	Valid range	Extra rule
Quantity (PO line, request line, receipt, issue)	Decimal(12,3)	> 0 and < 1,000,000,000	3 decimal places
Unit cost / unit price / selling prices / cost price	Decimal(12,2)	≥ 0	2 dp
Approved totals & approval limits	Decimal(14,2)	< 1,000,000,000,000	guarded against overflow
Discounts (commercial / financial / rappel)	Decimal(5,2)	each 0–100 ; combined ≤ 100	percentages
VAT rate	Decimal(5,4)	fraction 0 ... 1	e.g. 0.16 = 16%
Reorder level	Decimal(12,3)	≥ 0	0 = "no reorder trigger"
Internal code	CharField max 64	required on console create; letters, digits, ., -, _ only; stored uppercase; immutable after save (set-if-empty once for legacy)	unique, case-insensitive
Retail price (Genesis)	Decimal(12,2)	> 0 required on console create / first activation	wholesale/ special may stay 0
Reason / notes (reason fields)	CharField / TextField	reason ≤ 255 chars	over-long reason rejected
Email	EmailField	valid email	supplier & user
Stock balances (Item.quantity, BranchItemStock.quantity)	Decimal(12,3)	≥ 0	can't go negative

Field	Storage	Valid range	Extra rule
Reserved qty (<code>InternalRequestLine.quantity_reserved</code>)	<code>Decimal(12,3)</code>	≥ 0 and $\leq$ line quantity	claim on warehouse stock, not a ledger movement
Company Voice body	<code>TextField</code>	1-4000 characters after trim	empty rejected
Company Voice edit window	—	15 minutes from <code>created_at</code>	author only

Rounding: the whole app uses **half-away-from-zero** (`ROUND_HALF_UP` — not banker's rounding). Unit costs round to **4 dp** first, then line amounts (net / VAT / gross) round to **2 dp**.

4. State machines (every legal transition)

4.1 Purchase order



- Only **draft** lines are editable.
- **Cancel** is only from **approved** and only with **zero receipts**; otherwise **close** (short shipment).
- **Reject** requires a reason; **reopen** moves `rejected` → `draft`.

4.2 Internal request (requisição)



"Skip" transitions (both happen automatically, in the same action):

- First issue that finishes the warehouse side → **approved** → **shipped** directly (never persists `fulfilling`).
- First receipt that finishes the branch side → **shipped** → **closed** directly (never persists `received`).

Two short-closes:

Side	Who	Effect
Warehouse (/manage/ internal-requests/)	Manager grade 2+ / admin, reason	No dispatch yet (approved , zero issued) → closed . Partial issue (fulfilling) → unshipped remainder written off → shipped
Branch (/branch/ receipts/)	Manager / admin, reason	unreceived remainder written off → closed

No cancel after the first goods issue — short-close only.

Reservation (D32):

- **Approve** holds `min(remaining, unreserved on-hand)` on each line. A zero hold still approves (the request waits for stock).
- **Issue** may ship only from that line's reserved quantity. Incoming receipts / positive adjusts fill older backorders first (FIFO by `approved_at` , then request id, then line id).
- **Cancel** (approved, no issue) and **warehouse short-close** release the hold, then re-allocate free units to waiting lines.

4.3 Inactive entities (lock 9 / D16)

- **Inactive branch:** blocks new requests/lines/submit/approve, but **in-flight** issue / branch receipt / short-close still work (stock in transit isn't stuck).
- **Inactive item/family:** blocks new lines / submit / approve. Existing lines keep their **snapshots** and can still be fulfilled.

5. Money, VAT & pricing edge cases

Case	Behaviour
Selling price = 0	Means "not yet priced" — but a requisição line with wholesale = 0 is rejected
Buying price (cost)	From the primary supplier's price; if no primary, the cheapest supplier; if no prices at all → no cost shown
One primary per item	Marking a new supplier primary automatically un-marks the old one (DB-enforced)
Supplier price	Only for an active supplier and item; one cost per supplier×item
Approved totals	Frozen at approval — later price/VAT changes don't rewrite an approved PO/request (lines keep snapshots)
VAT	Stored as a fraction (<code>0.16</code>), applied per line at approval time
Discounts	Commercial + financial + rappel are all simple % now; combined > 100% is rejected

6. Concurrency & audit guarantees

These are guarantees, not "best effort":

- **No lost updates / no overselling:** every write that touches stock or an order **locks the rows** (`select_for_update`), and stock items are locked in a **fixed (sorted) order** to avoid

deadlocks. Two people receiving the last unit: one succeeds, the other gets an explicit "insufficient stock" error.

- **FIFO warehouse reservation:** approve holds the free portion for that requisição. A later branch cannot be issued those units. Issue is capped at the line's `quantity_reserved`. Incoming stock is offered to the oldest `approved / fulfilling` backorder first.
- **Append-only ledgers:** `StockMovement` and `BranchStockMovement` are never edited or deleted — only new rows. The cached `Item.quantity / BranchItemStock.quantity` are **computed** from the ledger; if they ever disagree, the ledger is the truth.
- **Frozen snapshots:** PO and request **lines** snapshot description, code, unit, VAT, price at creation/approval, so later master-data edits don't rewrite history.
- **Audit-by-design:** every create/update/lifecycle change writes a `*ChangeLog` row (`who` , `action` , `changes` , `reason` , `when`). There is no silent delete — deactivation/cancel instead. Company Voice uses `VoiceChangeLog` (created / edited / deleted) and **soft-delete** placeholders; Django admin cannot hard-delete Voice rows.
- **Company Voice row lock:** `delete_post` and `add_comment` lock the parent post (`select_for_update`). A first comment concurrent with parent delete cannot leave a live sub-thread on a tombstone. Two first comments share one sub-thread. Edits require the caller's `updated_at` and return **409** on a stale version.
- **Isolation:** one branch cannot read another branch's rows (404).

7. Known gaps (not built yet)

These are deliberate deferrals — ask before assuming they exist:

Gap	Status
Password reset	No self-service reset; an administrator resets it
Login rate-limiting	Done — 5 failures / 15 min (<code>accounts/throttle.py</code> ; configurable)
Email	<code>notify_supplier_on_approval</code> is a stub (logs only)
Offline / PWA	Not built (Phase 6 — after the 25 Aug chrome review)
Google OAuth / public signup	Google login-only is implemented; public signup is not
Linked / auto purchase order	Seam exists (nullable PO FK on request lines) but no automation
Branch-tiered prices	Only the 3 global selling prices (retail/wholesale/special)
Categories / vector or LLM search / bulk import	Not built

8. Account & session edge cases

- **Login is by email** — there is no username field.
- **Deactivated mid-session:** the next request returns "**Account is inactive**" (403) and signs you out — even with a still-valid session cookie.
- **Timezone:** every user has a timezone (default `Europe/Lisbon`); invalid timezones are rejected at save. Server-rendered dates are shown in the viewer's timezone; stored in UTC.
- `/admin/` is **superuser-only**. Warehouse and branch staff never log into Django admin.

- **Dual warehouse + branch user:** after login they land on the **warehouse dashboard** (/); branch pages are still reachable by URL/picker.

9. Decision trees (quick reference)

"**I can't cancel.**" - PO: has receipts? → **close** (short shipment), not cancel. - Request: already issued goods? → **short-close** (warehouse or branch), not cancel. - Request, no issue yet, but I'm an operator → manager/admin only.

"**I can't approve.**" - Operator → never. - Manager grade 1 → need grade 2+ (warehouse PO) / any manager (branch, within caps). - Over your cap → ask a higher-grade approver. - "No approval limit configured" → warehouse admin must set it.

"**I can't add a line.**" - Item inactive / family inactive / supplier inactive → reactivate. - Wholesale = 0 (requisição) / no supplier price (PO) → fix pricing. - Duplicate item on the document → edit the existing line.

"**My internal code was rejected.**" - Spaces or symbols (e.g. @, #) → use only letters, digits, ., -, _ . - Code already used (case-insensitive — cem-50 collides with CEM-50) → pick another. - Lowercase is fine — it is **saved as uppercase**.

"**I got 'insufficient stock' / 'cannot issue ... reserved'.**" - Issue: this request has no hold (or not enough) for that qty — a earlier approved requisição may be holding the units. Procure, wait, or short-close the earlier hold (reason required). - Receipt (branch): you typed more than the dispatch shipped.

10. Cross-references

- [Item Console](#) — catalogue, prices, families, suppliers, supplier prices.
- [Purchase Orders](#) — PO workflow, discounts, approval.
- [Goods receipt & stock](#) — receiving, stock ledger, adjustments.
- [Branches & Requisição interna](#) — the branch → warehouse → branch loop.
- [Manager catalog](#) — warehouse read-only stock + prices (/manage/catalog/).
- [Request threads](#) — catalogue-gap requests between branch and warehouse.